

Zhe Chen

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Resume Website: <https://summer-ikiki.github.io/zhe-chen-ai-gtm-bd/> | Portfolio Website: <https://summer-ikiki.github.io/zhe-chen-portfolio/>

AI GTM & Business Development Operator | Founder-Led Commercial Ownership | Partnership-Led Growth | Creator / Campus / Cross-Border Distribution

AI GTM, Business Development, and Growth Marketing operator with 7+ years across AI-native products, creator ecosystems, campus/community channels, agency-side marketing, and U.S.-China market expansion. As a Founder / CEO / BD lead, personally owned client, brand, sponsorship, vendor, university, and creator-partner conversations while reviewing commercial opportunities executed by team members. Proven record turning partnerships, owned content, communities, events, and creator networks into measurable adoption and revenue growth, including 800% user growth, 150K+ cumulative users, 100K+ partner-channel sign-ups, and 10x revenue growth.

SELECTED FIT FOR AI GTM / BD + MARKETING ROLES

- Built integrated AI/social GTM systems across partnerships, campus activation, creators, content, and community channels, driving **800% user growth** and **150K+ cumulative users**.
- Co-led partner-led campus campaigns, using **YikYak x Ditto** as a key activation across **733 U.S. universities** within a broader motion that converted **100K+ partner-channel sign-ups**.
- Delivered **8x YoY user growth** and **10x revenue growth** while building deep relationships across **70+ U.S. universities**, including Harvard, Stanford, and Cornell.
- Personally drove founder-level commercial conversations with clients, brands, sponsors, vendors, and creator partners while owning final commercial review.
- Built owned GTM distribution: **100K+ community reach**, **2,000+ influencer resources**, **1,000+ KOL/KOC network**, and **200+ brand collaboration resources**.
- Proved hands-on AI adoption through a **12,400+ user** Xiaohongshu (RED) copywriting AI Agent and a Brand You Claude Code article with **100K+ WeChat reads** and **11K+ shares**.
- Built public creator influence across Zhihu, Weibo, Xiaohongshu (RED), TikTok, and WeChat, including **30M+ Zhihu views**, a **6M-view Weibo post**, and **350K+ TikTok likes**.
- Founder and award-backed operator with **Internet+ National Silver** (3.4M+ entries; approx. top 0.03%), **Challenge Cup National Bronze**, **Beijing Outstanding Entrepreneurial Team Leader** recognition, **2 patents**, and an EI-indexed paper.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Marketing Director & Growth Lead | DITTO.AI (AI-Native Dating Platform)

Los Angeles, CA

Nov 2025 - Present

- Led campus growth and community strategy while coordinating marketing and BD workstreams with a **30+ member team**, driving **800% user growth** and adding **150K+ cumulative users**.
- Co-led an integrated campus GTM motion across partner collaboration, creative posters, a viral offline yacht activation, influencer marketing, and original videos, turning partner-led campaigns into **100K+ partner-channel sign-ups**.
- Used the **YikYak x Ditto** collaboration as one key partner activation across **733 U.S. universities** within a broader partner-led growth campaign.
- Built a **0-to-1 campus and community GTM system** across key U.S. cities, combining ambassador programs, campus poster networks, student organization partnerships, offline activations, creator/KOL content, and private-community conversion.
- Identified and validated a high-conversion targeted community channel with a **26.8% email verification rate**, approximately **20x above** the platform average, proving the value of precision community-led acquisition.
- Operated multi-platform communities across Discord, Telegram, and WeChat with **40K+ total members**; built campaign calendars, ambassador leaderboards, and UTM-based tracking to improve ROI visibility.
- Built AI-native marketing and product knowledge workflows for product specs, ops data, influencer marketing, and field marketing, reducing repetitive execution work and improving team decision speed.

Growth Marketing & Business Development Manager | ENCMOBILE (MEGATEL NETCOM CORPORATION)

Los Angeles, CA

May 2023 - Mar 2026

- Built the company's student-market marketing and partnership framework from scratch, integrating **paid media**, **community operations**, **local partnerships**, **campus channels**, and **website touchpoints** into a scalable growth model; delivered **8x YoY user growth** and **10x revenue growth**.
- Built deep relationships and strong BD penetration across **70+ U.S. universities**, including Harvard, Stanford, Cornell, Yale, UCLA, and USC.
- Negotiated partnerships with **40+ vendors** and **60+ student organizations**, expanding local distribution and reducing partnership costs by **50%**.
- Coordinated **60+ North American university events annually**, building a practical resource base across LA venues, vendors, media partners, campus organizations, and student ambassadors.
- Managed Google Ads, Meta Ads, Amazon Ads, and Baidu SEO/SEM initiatives; partnered with agencies and internal teams to optimize channel spend, audience targeting, campaign ROI, and acquisition messaging.
- Built Tableau-based dashboards and recurring review routines for campaign pacing, user segmentation, channel performance, and student-market conversion insights.
- Managed six-figure to multi-million scale budgets and coordinated a **50+ member execution team**; awarded **Best Sales Champion (2024)** for business impact and execution.

Founder | GTM & BD Lead | PANDAPAL (Global Digital Solutions Provider & Marketing Agency; AI Campus Community Product)

Los Angeles, CA

Aug 2021 - Jan 2025

- Built PANDAPAL as both a **global digital solutions provider / marketing agency** and a **0-to-1 AI campus community product**, reaching **100K+ members** across Xiaohongshu (RED), TikTok, Discord, Telegram, and WeChat.
- Built both a youth community brand and a marketing / digital solutions business, delivering creator/community, content, event, and campaign solutions for **200+ brands and partners**.
- Personally led founder-level BD with brands, sponsors, vendors, and creator partners, building **200+ brand collaboration resources** and validating **3 monetization models**.
- Built and activated **2,000+ influencer resources** and a **1,000+ KOL/KOC network** across Xiaohongshu (RED), TikTok, Instagram, and creator communities.
- Grew a **40K+ campus network** across **50+ U.S. universities**, managed **50+ active community groups**, and organized **30+ campus / community events**, creating a repeatable base for partner campaigns and student-market distribution.
- Orchestrated **20+ digital campaigns** reaching **600K+ users**; translated creator insights into content briefs, campaign calendars, user education materials, and product launch assets.
- Grew a Xiaohongshu (RED) account from 0 to **7K+ followers**; first note reached **1M views** and converted **1,000 targeted users** into private community channels.
- Launched and operated **Panda Youth FM**, a youth-focused podcast brand, to extend community trust into long-form storytelling and founder-led audience building.
- Independently built a **Xiaohongshu Viral Copywriting AI Agent** on Coze, ranked #1 on Xiaohongshu's copywriting tool leaderboard with **12,400+ users**.
- Led team to win **national entrepreneurship awards**, strengthening product, GTM, and founder-execution credibility.

Product Marketing & Community Lead | STAR REALMS (VR Game)

Los Angeles, CA

Jan 2022 - 2023

- Built and managed a **50K+ cross-platform community** across Discord, WeChat, Telegram, TikTok, LinkedIn, X, Xiaohongshu (RED), and Zhihu for a VR social metaverse startup.
- Supported 0-to-1 VR social launch planning and a **\$400K fundraise** through university partnerships, seed-user feedback loops, product education content, and **10+ product / market strategy decks**.

Founder & Product/GTM Lead | PEACHJAM / Legend Co-Shooting, AI + Film Resource Sharing and AI-Assisted Video Production Platform

Beijing / Zhejiang / Los Angeles

2018 - Jun 2022

- Founded an AI-assisted film and video production platform focused on creator collaboration, production resource matching, and workflow automation; won **"Internet+" National Silver Award** (3.4M+ entries; approx. top 0.03%), **"Challenge Cup" National Bronze**, and **Beijing Outstanding Entrepreneurial Team Leader** recognition.
- Owned founder-level commercial conversations with creators, production partners, sponsors, and resource providers while building a **3,000+ professional creator community** and aggregating **6,000+ film production resources**.
- Designed creator workflow modules from script and storyboard import to scene breakdown, shot lists, shooting schedules, props lists, camera movement guidance, editing templates, and auto-subtitles.
- Produced and distributed independent film **"Mount & Sea"**, reaching **1.114M views** and **105K likes** on Bilibili in week one.

- Supported Pacific Creative Park business development and operations for a **28,000 sqm** creative park; closed **20+ merchant deals**, supported **100% occupancy**, and generated approximately **RMB 500K incremental annual revenue** through equipment rentals and live-commerce related services.
- Managed budgets and partner delivery across **20+ creative / production projects**, reducing external production costs by approximately **10%** through vendor consolidation and delivery discipline.
- Led a **40+ person cross-functional team** and reduced delivery cycle by **50%** through workflow standardization across creative, product, operations, and agency partners.

SELECTED AI-NATIVE / FOUNDER PROJECTS

- **SWAP (Skill-Exchange Platform) | Co-Founder & Marketing Partner:** Drove **100K+ users** through product positioning, Xiaohongshu growth, offline activation, and user-education content.
- **Brand You (AI-Native Action Community Brand) | Initiator & Co-Founder:** Published an independent Claude Code tutorial with **100K+ WeChat reads**, **11K+ shares**, 2,467 likes, and 1,092 saves/favorites.

ADDITIONAL COMMERCIAL & MARKETING EXPERIENCE

- **Marketing & Content Operation | YAMI (Asian Food E-Commerce):** Built 10+ customer communities with **2,000+ members** and managed Xiaohongshu (RED), WeChat, Instagram, and private-community operations; achieved **22% conversion**, **60% repurchase**, **1M+ campaign reach**, **25% ROI improvement**, and **\$50K direct order conversions**; awarded Sales Champion.
- **Marketing & Content Operation | HUNGRYPANDA:** Produced **10+ viral Xiaohongshu posts** and **6 high-performing WeChat articles** with 1,000+ likes each, planned **20+ campus campaigns**, added **1,500+ users**, built **8 active communities**, and used Tableau-based audience profiling to refine campus promotion playbooks.
- **Digital Marketing & Customer Strategy | SKYWALKER COMMUNICATIONS (4A Agency):** Supported PR / branding and media strategy for enterprise clients including Fortune Global 500 industrial client Weichai Power and Sinotruk; contributed to CCTV scheduling, media pacing, KPI alignment, and post-campaign reviews, lifting exposure / share of voice by approximately **30%**.
- **Publicity & Production | Beijing Hengdian Film Group:** Conducted audience research through desk research, surveys, and focus groups; contributed to **3 release / marketing plans** and improved trailer, key-art, and creative asset consistency by approximately **20%**.
- **Business Development | Wanda Wuzhou Film Distribution:** Led **10+ campus screenings** with **1,200+ attendees** and approximately **70% community join rate**, managed **5 cinephile communities** with **1,000+ members**, increased repeat participation by **50%**, and closed **5 brand sponsorships**.
- **Digital Marketing | Sohu Media:** Supported Sofa Video campus promotion, user research, content timing, and placement optimization; improved section engagement by approximately **5%** and was recognized as **Best Intern**.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Digital Social Media | University of Southern California

Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism | Los Angeles, CA | GPA: 3.89/4

Aug 2021 - May 2023

- USC Student Success Fund recipient; Public Relations Leader, USC Chinese Graduate Student Association; Founder, USC Chinese Student Digital Community.

BA in Theatre, Film & TV Directing / BA in Digital Film & TV Production | Communication University of China / New York Institute of Technology

CUC GPA: 3.79/4, Rank 2 (Top 8%) | NYIT GPA: 3.80/4, Rank 1

Sep 2017 - Jun 2021

- Grand Prize Scholarship for Entrepreneurship (sole recipient); led **11 award-winning projects** out of 18 and earned **5 national-level entrepreneurship awards**.

AWARDS, RESEARCH & PUBLIC INFLUENCE

- **National entrepreneurship awards:** Internet+ Innovation Contest National Silver (3.4M+ entries; approx. top 0.03%), Challenge Cup National Bronze, Beijing Outstanding Entrepreneurial Team Leader, Grand Prize Scholarship for Entrepreneurship (sole recipient), and 5 national-level entrepreneurship awards.
- **Research / IP:** 2 national patents including one invention patent, an EI-indexed paper, and contribution to *The Essence of Chinese Folk Culture*.
- **Zhihu:** 15K+ followers, **30M+ views**, 60K+ saves, 101K+ likes, and 30K+ shares across creator / culture / product content.
- **Weibo:** 10K+ followers; selected for Weibo's V Light Program; one post reached **6M views**.
- **Xiaohongshu (RED):** 7K+ followers across 2 accounts; debut note reached **1M views** and validated private-community conversion.
- **TikTok:** Built short-video traction with **350K+ cumulative likes** and 700% engagement growth.

CORE SKILLS

BD & Partnerships: Business Development, Founder-Led BD, Commercial Partnership Development, Ecosystem Partnerships, Partner-Led Growth, Partner Activation, Co-Marketing, Client Discovery, Deal Scoping, Use-Case Framing, Vendor Negotiation, Strategic Account Support, Cross-Border Partnerships. **GTM & Growth:** AI GTM, GenAI use-case framing, MaaS business model awareness, GTM Strategy, Demand Generation, Growth Marketing, Owned Distribution, Community-Led Growth, Offline-to-Online Conversion, Lifecycle Messaging, UTM Tracking, ROI Review, Campaign Post-Mortems. **AI & Creator Ecosystems:** AI Workflow Adoption, Creator Ecosystem, Xiaohongshu (RED), TikTok, Instagram, Discord, Telegram, WeChat, Zhihu, Weibo, Coze, Claude, Codex, Cursor, Notion AI. **Paid / Analytics / Content:** Tableau, GA4, PostHog, Excel, Google Ads, Meta Ads, Amazon Ads, Baidu SEO/SEM, Semrush, WordPress, Final Cut Pro, Premiere Pro, After Effects, DaVinci Resolve, CapCut, Photoshop, Illustrator. **Certifications & Languages:** Hootsuite Platform Certification, Google Analytics Certification; Mandarin native; English full professional proficiency.